

It is terribly frustrating when it happens to you. Consumers spent from four to 130 hours of their time fixing ID theft problems. Problems usually involve the misuse of a credit card account, misuse of accounts other than credit cards, and the opening of new accounts in another person's name. Many victims suffer multiple types of identity theft. The best advice to get the issue taken care of immediately is to say these two magic words to your bank or your credit card company. The banks will pay attention to you then. They hate identity theft as much as you do.

While I was writing this book, a friend called to lament that someone was using her debit card information and racking up charges all over Chicago! Meredith still had her card in her purse – someone had somehow gotten the information from the magnetic strip and made a fake card. There are sophisticated card readers that will steal your info, and there are shifty cashiers in the best of establishments. You never know when it could happen to you. Jolted from the complacency of thinking it would never happen to her, Meredith now gladly pays the small fee for credit report monitoring.

Remember the two magic words “*identity theft*.” It is highly possible that there is an item on your credit report that may not be yours at all! And the bad credit score that you get as a result actually does not belong to you. You could be denied credit because of something that some crook did, and you pay the cost, literally. If you are not getting a good credit score, you need to be alert to the fact that there could be an unexplained item on your report, and you could be the victim of identity theft.

If there is something on your credit report that is a total mystery, you need to tell the credit card company or the bank that it is just not yours! Two magic words = identity theft. You should be able to get immediate improvement!

Identity Theft Facts

It is a sad fact that in this world we live in, people will steal anything, especially your financial well-being. Not that anything good can come of identity theft, but Kurt was finally able to resolve this issue with the mysterious \$15,000 that had appeared on his credit report.